

Fujian Wanchen Food (300972.SZ): NDR takeaway: Scaling New Heights with Resilient Store UE, OP Efficiencies, and PL Momentum; Reiterate

We hosted Wanchen's mgmt team (retail business CFO) for investor meetings and came away with stronger **confidence in both the visibility of 2026 growth and the sustainability of its longer-term growth trajectory**. We reiterate our view that value-retailers are well positioned to capture a fair share of the benefits they create through improved value-chain efficiency/enhanced customer value/enriched products offering, **while industry leaders are fostering a healthy retail ecosystem supported by disciplined competitive strategies and expect margins upside** on improving operating efficiency and excellence. **We reiterate Buy on attractive 12.8x/9.5x 2026E/27E P/E** vs. GSe of 51%/93% sales/NP growth in 2026E and 19%/27% CAGR in 2026-28E.

Key highlights include:

1) Healthy SSSG despite rapid expansion reinforces confidence in the long-term store runway: Mgmt reiterated its **FY26 target of no fewer than 8k net store openings** (vs. 5.8k in 1H26) and does not anticipate any meaningful slowdown in 4Q, noting that fast 3Q store roll-out continued to yield resilient SSSG. Mgmt highlighted ample runway remains, validated by **i) 70~80% of 1H26 openings concentrated in stronghold markets** (store map [here](#)); **ii) solid SD% growth in 1H26 per-store GMV** despite accelerated roll-out, with SSSG running even faster (e.g., for penetrated markets such as Jiangsu adding 1,000 stores YTD to reach 4,000 stores still seeing positive SSSG); **iii) significant whitespace opportunities in both lower-tier markets and underpenetrated neighborhood locations in prefecture-level cities.**

2) Store UE remains healthy with 2-year avg. payback period; lower-tier markets offer attractive economics: Mgmt indicated average store payback period remains around two years with no material difference between stronghold/competing markets, together with even better UE as penetrating into townships (due to lower rent/labor costs, despite below-avg. store GMV). Franchisee GPM broadly remains stable at c. 19% with slight upside yielding healthy store UE together with solid per store GMV.

3) Supply-chain efficiencies and digitalization investments support further margin improvement: Mgmt noted **GPM retains room for sequential improvement**, driven by procurement savings (scale)/warehouse optimization (reducing delivery distance)/ fulfillment efficiency gains. **Mgmt expects 2H26 NPM to remain broadly stable HoH**, with slight GPM accretion (also efficiency gain in logistic cost ratio) with flat or slightly higher expense ratio HoH due to talent

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incentives/digitalization investments (while FY26 expense ratios should still improve YoY), emphasizing that **near-term priorities remain focused on ecosystem health rather than margin maximization**, with most efficiency gains/scale benefits continuing to be shared with franchisees and within the value chain. Mgmt emphasized that **store-opening subsidies** remain immaterial and **are lower on an average per-store basis YoY**, as 1H26 new openings more focuses on stronghold markets that require significantly less subsidy support (e.g., zero store-open subsidies in some stronghold provinces), signaling rational competitive strategy.

4) Private-label and new category expansion/membership ecosystem to drive repurchase and support per store GMV performance: Mgmt highlighted that over 50% of SKUs are sourced from leading F&B brands (c.60% of GMV). Meanwhile, **private-label (“PL”) and co-developed products have become a growing focus** and marked several blockbusters SKUs (e.g., PL packaged water), with the portfolio expanding to 60-70 SKUs by end-June (vs. only c. 10 SKUs in 3Q25) covering 6 major categories (currently c.3% of total GMV) and expected to cover all the 12 major categories by year-end. In July 2026, 25% of monthly active users (c.100mn) purchased PL products (increasing MoM), while penetration of PL among new customers reached c.13%. Mgmt noted that the primary objective of developing PL is to **enhance value for customers and empower core category’s growth** (e.g., successful co-branded UHT milk products with leading brands have driven overall UHT milk category’s growth without diluting branded SKUs’ performance) while the PL products also carry relatively **higher store-level margins for franchisees within the same category**. Future product expansion will remain focused on **chilled and frozen foods** (to go nationwide in 1~2 years, as 4% of GMV now), while maintaining a streamlined assortment of daily necessities/IP-related products. **Membership program continues to drive engagement** with member monthly ARPU reaching **Rmb130~140** vs.c.Rmb90 on average, while core members shopping frequency can reach 3.8x vs. 3.2~3.3x for mature consumers.

5) Continued improvement in operation efficiency: Following rapid nationwide expansion over the past 2-3 years, the company added operating backbone personnel and continued to improve talent incentives. Headquarters increasingly focuses on management and digitalization of front-line operations, including AI-combined store location selection in business development, and counter and weighting monitoring in store operation, as well as logistic and warehousing optimization, which will help to support L-T margin expansion.

The authors would like to thank Lily Qi for her contribution to this report.

Also read:

Fujian Wanchen Food (300972.SZ): 2Q26 Review: Strong beat in sales/store openings with core NPM sequentially improving qoq; Positive simple avg. sales per store yoy; Buy

China Consumer Staples: MOC announced policy guideline to support county level consumption; High-level implications for our value retailer coverage with deep low-tier penetration

China Staples: Navigating Channel Transformation #3: Mapping Value Retailer store expansion YTD: the strong get stronger; the dense get denser, white space remains

China Staples: Value Retailers: Market concerns overdone; strong store expansion with healthier closure ratio/resilient SSSG; Reiterate Buy

China Staples: Value Retailers: Our three key takes on read-across from new booming Fresh Snacks retail chains

Price Target Risks and Methodology – Fujian Wanchen Food

Price Target Risks and Methodology – Fujian Wanchen Food

Our 12m TP is Rmb327, based on a target 2027E P/E at 18x discounted back to mid-2027 at an 8.2% COE. The target P/E is based on Average 2027E P/E of global listed value-focused retail peers Dollar General/Dollar Tree/Ryohin Keikaku/Pan Pacific International Holdings/YUMC.

Key risks: 1) intensifying market competition and price sustainability; 2) franchise model risk and scaling complexity; 3) M&A risks; 4) supply chain, food safety and logistics.

300972.SZ	12m Price Target: Rmb327.00	Price: Rmb184.56	Upside: 77.2%
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Buy	GS Forecast				
Market cap: Rmb35.1bn / \$5.2bn Enterprise value: Rmb30.2bn / \$4.5bn 3m ADTV: Rmb433.6mn / \$64.2mn China China Consumer Staples M&A Rank: 3 Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: Yes	Revenue (Rmb mn)	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
	EBITDA (Rmb mn)	51,459.1	77,672.2	97,842.9	109,720.1
	EPS (Rmb)	3,295.0	5,508.6	7,396.8	8,781.2
	P/E (X)	7.29	14.10	19.00	22.62
	P/B (X)	20.4	13.1	9.7	8.2
	Dividend yield (%)	11.0	5.6	3.1	2.0
	N debt/EBITDA (ex lease,X)	0.7	1.1	1.5	1.7
	CROCI (%)	(1.0)	(1.3)	(1.8)	(2.2)
	FCF yield (%)	NM	NM	NM	NM
		12.5	11.7	15.5	16.6
		3/26	6/26E	9/26E	12/26E
	EPS (Rmb)	0.00	0.00	4.68	4.90

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 9 Sep 2026 close.

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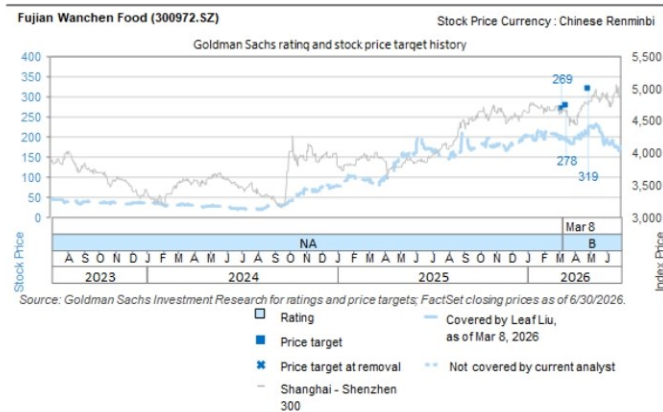
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Target price history table(s)

Fujian Wanchen Food (300972.SZ)

Date of report	Target price (Rmb)	Closing price (Rmb)
30-Aug-26	327.00	194.38
07-Jul-26	324.00	196.21
28-Apr-26	319.00	203.81
17-Mar-26	278.00	192.10
08-Mar-26	269.00	201.81

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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